

Company: Blackrock

Job Profile: Software Engineer

Offer Type: Internship

Internship Stipend: 50k

CTC: 18LPA (Performance based PPO)

Location: Gurgaon/Mumbai (Not specified)

Process Date: 28th August

Placement Process:

This was a pool campus recruitment process so probably it took place simultaneously in other colleges too. Pre-placement talk was conducted along with VIT Pune students on Webex. Total 3 rounds took place after Pre-placement talk.

- OA (Technical and aptitude test)
- Tech Interview 1
- Tech Interview 2

1. **Online Technical+Aptitude test** [Approx. 100 students appeared for this round]

The CGPA criteria to apply was 7.5 and above. Having a proper resume format ([Jake's](#) preferably) and one good project with unique features(Can be Major project) along with a couple of basic personal projects is sufficient to make your resume get shortlisted in campus placements. Make sure to write the project description in the form of pointers(the various features). Also, don't completely rely on gpt instead list down in your own words and refine it using gpt. Try to keep the project that sells more at the top.

The test was conducted on the eLitmus platform and was proctored. As Blackrock visited for the first time, we had no interview experience to refer to. So, I searched the web for test formats/questions and prepared accordingly and the test format/topics were not different. Test duration was 1.5 hours , having 3 sections: **Aptitude**: Had 3 subsections - Quants ; Data Checking/Data Accuracy(was easy) ; Logical reasoning(pattern recognition,sequences,etc).Solving maximum without wasting time is key!

Programming : Had 2 subsections - Flowcharts.Given 2 flowcharts of some basic problem and contains 5-6 blanks which we were to identify and MCQs based on those. 1 was some string matching algo and the other was easy enough ; Pseudocodes. They gave 3 pseudocode based MCQs. Two were based on binary trees/BSTs(basic insertion,deletion,traversal,depth) and one on AVL trees(rotateLeft,rotateRight operations). I prepared on these topics beforehand and thus was able to solve this section confidently.

SQL: There were 20 MCQs on Oracle SQL and were mostly theoretical.Time given was more than enough. I was aware of most of the functions in mySQL and solved SQL50 on leetcode. Though Oracle SQL is a bit different syntactically, I tried to trust my gut and marked accordingly in some questions.

One thing I had learned about OA's in 2 months of placement season is that **YOU NEED TO HAVE TRUST IN YOURSELF AND IN YOUR PREPARATION**. This doesn't mean you have always prepared all the topics completely and have an overconfident attitude. Instead, you are well aware of what all you have prepared and what not and need to own that truth. Enjoy the test when the time comes. Breathe and take it slow, keep your mind focused in the present! **THE MOST IMP THING: PLEASE PREPARE APTITUDE** (Quants, LR, everything) properly from Indiabix. I fumbled a lot in aptitude tests till I was confident and became good.

2. **Technical Interview 1** [27 students appeared for this round]

A total of 27 students (across all 3 roles) got selected for the interviews. 8 additional candidates were on the waitlist but they didn't get a chance for an interview at the end. For the SE role, 18 appeared for interviews. The interview process was conducted **online** on Webex.

The interview started with a warm greeting followed by my introduction. After that he told me to walk through and explain my Major project (which was the highlight). I explained what it is, what problem we are solving (the need) and the main features of the project. Further, he asked me to explain the tech stack used which led to a detailed conversation about how the architecture of the project was, about the database used, about Next.js. He basically was testing the low-level implementation details and whether I have actually worked on the project. He also asked about any conflict which might have occurred while working on the group project. I was prepared for such questions.

After that he asked me to explain what OOP is. I explained about how some languages are functional programming languages and others object oriented languages. Gave an example - python being more on the functional side (i was wrong) and explained it further how python supports both upon intervention. Then he asked to explain encapsulation, Inheritance, polymorphism. Always remember to give **examples**!

To end off, he asked me a very common [puzzle](#). I was very aware of such common puzzles but I had never read the solutions :(Though I very well knew they were interested in the approach. So I was able to smartly handle this and come up with a solution. Then he gave a last minute effort to optimize it and was able to do so. Lastly, I asked him one question regarding the technologies used at Blackrock.

Before leaving, he himself said that the HR will inform me about the next round shortly!

3. **Technical Interview 2** [16 students appeared for this round]

The 2nd tech interview was a techno-HR for some of my friends. For me, it was completely a tech round.

This round started with greetings and a short conversation on how was my experience of the 1st round to which I told him honestly how I tackled the last puzzle in the previous round.

Then he asked me to explain one of my favourite projects. I explained my major project. Then I was asked about my contribution; I spoke about the features I worked on. Then he asked me to explain the kanban board functionality which I built, supabase db used. Further he asked me to explain what is authentication and authorization which led to a to and fro conversation on how exactly it works behind the scenes. He was not interested in the token generation-cookies and session storage part but on whether the database is queried on each auth request and similarly for authorization. Further I was asked about enum in Java. I explained that it is a special class in java, where it is used (Gave an example of how I defined roles using an Enum in db schema. It is good if you bring up a concept which you have used in your project). Then as I spoke about

RBAC in my project he asked me to open notepad and design the Roles table and how authorization will take place. For this I designed 2 more tables to explain him properly about the end-to-end flow. Remember to be confident in what you explain and always keep talking!

He then posed an open ended question: If you have data which is coming from multiple sources, what **rules** will you define to normalize/preprocess it and store correct data? I started with the use of python for data preprocessing and the different techniques used as I got a sense that he was not expecting 1NF,2NF,3NF. Then he clarified that I just need to give a rule to be imposed(low-level). For which I answered :A very general and straightforward rule would be to check matching data for each attribute.If it matches, there is high probability that the data is correct. Further for unmatched fields, I will check existing database and look for a match. I honestly did not know what he was expecting, but he was satisfied with my answer.

The last part of interview was: A binary tree implementation and function to search for a value in tree.

He told me to open notepad and code. It is a good practice to talk about each and every line of code on what you are doing. Further he gave 2 followups- finding the no. of occurrences of that element and the deepest level of that element. He wanted me to implement all 3 in the same function .I tried but afterwards, I used global variables and stored the value for each and explained. He told me it can be done without this but what I did was correct.

At the end I asked for a feedback (he said good things!) ; asked him about some interesting project which he has worked on and a pleasant 2 min conversation went on.

4. **HR Round(Prank round)** [13 students]

We were told due to some unfortunate reasons, Blackrock is terminating the process but TPO is requesting them. 10 students were called the next day for an HR round. This was just a small unofficial 1 on 1 conversation with Sikka Sir after which the results were announced by Sir himself in the conference room along with some words of inspiration.He announced that 10 students were selected and 3 were on waitlist. (7 SE, 2 Aladdin data, 1 GM)

10 students were offered the job and I was one of them!

Useful Tips:

- 1) First of all be clear on your motto, mine was-To get placed in a good company which can help me kickstart my career and offer growth opportunities.
- 2) **Start early** - This might be the only fruitful decision which determines how smooth your placement journey will be. I learned it the hard way. I started late but turns out I was capable enough to survive.Don't get discouraged if you start late.
- 3) Be aware and plan out things- Always list down or atleast be aware of what you need to prepare.Initially I did not prepare the Core subjects- DBMS>OS>CCN. Later it becomes tough to cope up with extra preparation.
- 4) **Focus on Aptitude preparation** - You'll think its easy, but there may be 30 people better than you always! I learned after failing a lot of aptitude tests. In the end, I significantly improved and had more faith in myself for the first time than my best friends had in me lol :)
- 5) Reach out to seniors who got placed last year just before any company process starts to get to know about their personal experience/ about the company and the roles. Also, If there is any company

which is new, reach out on LinkedIn to random seniors(not necessarily from your college).People are always ready to help.This helped me for a couple of interviews.

- 6) Look up on failures and rejections and keep on telling yourself, there is a better opportunity waiting for you in the future which would be worth cracking and you'll savor that moment. Also, learn from them and retrospect on what went wrong exactly and iteratively improve yourself on those parts.

Short story: After the Blackrock test, the results were announced a week later unlike other companies which have interviews the next day or day after. I got a message from TPO that interview was the next day and I was at my native place for Ganpati festival which gave me just 2 hours to revise and prep after reaching home.But as I was prepared to tackle whichever question I missed previously , I was confident the next day and things fell into place perfectly!

Last and not the least, these interview experiences are useful for you to get to know about some quirky/unusual questions. But remember these are just memoirs of the ones who slayed and everything went smooth for them during the process. So don't completely rely on past experiences.

For eg: If you come across a topic asked, try to learn about 5 more topics related to it and in detail. This preparation depth will matter as change in the job market is exponential in nature due to drastic developments in AI.

BEST OF LUCK & ALL THE BEST!!

You'll get prep material sources/links from other experiences.

If not,

Feel free to reach out to me for any help:

Whatsapp- 9321756250 | [LinkedIn](#)